

box) gathered momentum as the unification of the country progressed. In 1859, nationalists adopted the slogan “Viva Verdi” as shorthand for “Viva Vittorio Emanuele Re d’Italia” (“Long Live Victor Emmanuel King of Italy”).



LA TRAVIATA SCORE, 1853

In Verdi's opera about passion and loss, Violetta is forced to give up her lover, Alfredo, by his father. The work was only successful after Verdi revised it in 1854.

Fame and fortune

After the declaration of the Kingdom of Italy in 1861, Verdi was persuaded to accept election to parliament, though he rarely